

Cold-Call Audition Preparation

Interview Prep - Skill: interview - Difficulty: intermediate - Est. 15 min

Draft resource pending human editorial review - not yet professionally verified.

Preparation for the live mock cold call many SDR interviews include: what they are assessing, how to prepare an adaptable opener, and how to stay composed when the "prospect" pushes back.

Learning objectives

- Understand what a mock-call assessor looks for
- Prepare an adaptable opener and one question
- Stay calm through an objection
- Debrief your own performance honestly

What they usually assess

- Can you open clearly and get to the point?
- Do you ask a question and listen, or just pitch?
- How do you react to a "not interested"?
- Are you coachable when they give feedback?

Prepare in four steps

1. Write a short, adaptable opener you can say naturally.
2. Prepare one open question and one calm objection response.
3. Run the mock with the AI Coach audition track twice.
4. Debrief: one thing you did well, one thing to adjust.

Worked example (composure)

Assessor: "I am not interested." You: "That is fair - can I ask one quick thing and then let you go? Is it the timing, or just not a fit right now?" Staying curious and calm under a brush-off usually scores higher than a perfect script.

Safe-practice note

Show your real ability rather than a memorised performance; assessors can tell. If you are nervous, it is fine to say so briefly and continue. Do not fabricate experience during the mock - being coachable matters more than sounding polished.